ENG-0018 - Ledger-Service System Postmortem

Impact

The ledger-service, a critical component within Project Quasar, experienced two recent incidents, INC-032 and INC-095, both classified as Sev2 severity. These incidents resulted in service disruptions that affected operational workflows and required a total resolution time of 31 hours (15.5 hours each). Given the system's high criticality, the disruptions posed significant risks to project timelines and data integrity.

Timeline

- **INC-032** was reported by E-042 and logged as a deployment error affecting the ledger-service. The incident was resolved in 15.5 hours.
- **INC-095** was similarly reported by E-042, also identified as a deployment error, and resolved in the same duration of 15.5 hours.
- Both incidents occurred within a close timeframe, highlighting recurring issues related to deployment processes.

Root Cause

Analysis indicates that both incidents stemmed from deployment errors. The root cause category has been identified as deployment_error, suggesting procedural or technical deficiencies during deployment activities contributed to the system disruptions.

Action Items

- Review and enhance deployment procedures to prevent recurrence of deployment errors.
- Conduct targeted training for deployment teams, emphasizing best practices and error mitigation.
- Implement additional monitoring during deployment phases to detect issues proactively.
- Aimee Montoya, in her role as the on-call employee, will oversee the implementation of these corrective measures and coordinate with the deployment team.
- Further investigation into the deployment process should be initiated to identify systemic vulnerabilities and incorporate automation where feasible.

Additional Context

The ledger-service is owned by Project Quasar, which was completed on December 10, 2024. The project is managed under department D-08, with Michelle Evans serving as the project lead. The system's tech stack includes Go, gRPC, and Redis, and it is managed with high criticality. The on-call engineer for ledger-service is Aimee Montoya, a HR Business Partner based in Brisbane, who has been with the company since July 1, 2018.

This postmortem aims to improve system resilience and ensure the continued reliability of ledger-service within the enterprise infrastructure.